Talk Light Trigger

Quick reference — controls & first-run setup

Listens to a talkback mic/bus input and fires a dLive Scene recall whenever the level crosses a threshold — one Scene while quiet, a different one while talkback is active. Point each Scene's Surface Illumination at a different colour and the console's lights flash with talkback.

Menu bar icon

Click	Show / hide the control panel.
Right-click	Quit the app (there's no Dock icon or app menu — this is the only way to quit).
Icon colour	Grey = stopped. Blue = running, listening (quiet). Bright = talkback active.

Connection

Choose one. Both reach the console the same way underneath — pick whichever needs less new software.

Direct TCP	Opens its own connection to the MixRack. Enter the console's IP (Host) — Port defaults to 51325.
Existing MIDI Port	Sends over a MIDI port already routed to the console — most easily the free **dLive MIDI Bridge**, or A&H's driver / loopMIDI / IAC. Pick it from the dropdown. When the port is dLive MIDI Bridge, this app identifies itself by name ("Talk Light Trigger") in the bridge's MIDI Monitor instead of showing as a generic connection.
Base MIDI Channel	Must match Utility → Control → MIDI on the console.

Audio Input

Device	The audio interface carrying the talkback signal.
Channel	Which input channel on that device to listen to.

Scenes

Quiet Scene #	Scene recalled while the input is below threshold.
Talkback Scene #	Scene recalled while talkback is active.
Flash Rate	While talkback is active, the app alternates the Quiet and Talkback Scenes at this rate instead of holding on the Talkback Scene — the console lights actually flash.
Flash Hold	How long the flash carries on after talkback stops (default 3 s), so a short pause doesn't cut the lights off. Talking again inside the hold just keeps it going. **Off** = the flash follows the microphone exactly.

Important — on the console, save two Scenes with different dimmer values in Surface → Control → Dimmer. Both Scenes must have their Recall Filter restricted to Surface Illumination only. Without this, recalling either Scene changes the whole mix, not just the lights.

Sensitivity

Threshold	Level the input has to cross to count as "talking."
Attack Time	Time above Threshold required before it triggers (avoids brief noise/breath sounds).
Release	How far below Threshold the level must drop before counting as quiet again (avoids flicker at the edge).
Min Retrigger	Minimum time between Scene recalls, even if the level keeps crossing back and forth.

Cancel SoftKey

*Needs **Direct TCP** or an **Existing MIDI Port** that can receive — not available when pointed at a MIDI Bridge lane. This is the only thing in this app that ever receives MIDI; audio input still decides quiet vs. talking on its own.*

Enable	Listens for a console SoftKey to stop the flash the moment it's pressed.
Cancel CC #	The Control Change number your SoftKey sends (default 127).
What to type on the console	Set the SoftKey to **Custom MIDI** and type the string the panel shows, exactly — it updates as you change the CC # or Base MIDI Channel. It is three comma-separated hex bytes: **B** + (base channel − 1) in hex, the CC # in hex, then **01**. Base channel 12, CC 127 → **BB,7F,01**; base channel 1, CC 127 → **B0,7F,01**.
Cancel Cooldown	How long the flash stays off after a press. It resumes on its own after this, if still talking — no need to press again.

Running it

Start / Stop	Opens (or closes) the audio input and begins (or stops) watching the level.
Status tile	Stopped / Quiet / Active — mirrors the menu bar icon colour.
First launch	macOS will prompt for microphone access the first time you click Start — allow it, or the app won't receive any audio.

Bitfocus Companion

Connects on 127.0.0.1:8771 — the "Bitfocus Companion" row in the panel shows whether it's connected.

Allow Companion control	On by default (this Mac only). Companion can press Run and adjust Threshold; turn off to stop accepting remote presses — the panel still shows why.
Lock show-critical controls	Off by default. When on, Companion can't switch Run off (turning it on remains available).
What Companion sees	Run/Threshold as buttons, plus Running, Talk state, Level, Threshold and both Scene numbers as variables and feedbacks.

If something goes wrong

Export log	Click **Export log** in the panel footer. A diagnostics zip lands on your Desktop and opens in Finder — this session's log, the previous one, and your settings (licence details removed). Send that zip with your report; nothing leaves your Mac unless you send it.
What the log holds	Your settings at launch and each change, the audio and MIDI devices present, every Start and Stop, every error the panel showed you, your licence or trial state. Every launch is logged automatically; nothing to switch on.
The log folder	Right-click the menu bar icon and choose **Open Log Folder** (**~/Library/Logs/dylanmaudio/Talk Light Trigger/**, newest 20 launches kept).
Send feedback	Also in the footer — a short message straight to me, no email client needed.

What's new in v1.2.1

• Fixed: on some Macs, most often older Intel Macs, opening the panel or pressing Rescan could interrupt the audio input for a moment, because listing your audio and MIDI devices briefly paused the app. It now lists them without that pause.
• Fixed: with the MIDI Port set to dLive Bridge (MIDI Bridge) and the Cancel SoftKey ticked, Start showed "Cancel SoftKey is on but this connection can't receive MIDI" for the whole run, which read as an error. The SoftKey can't be heard through MIDI Bridge, so the option is now greyed out there, with the reason beside it: it needs Direct TCP or another MIDI port. The Cancel flash button works on every connection.